Clemens Mill School Council
Meeting Minutes
May 13, 2026

ATTENDEES
(V = voting member)

Robert Wilson - Principal
Andi Gourlay - Vice-Principal
Cheraine Serrador - Chair
Carrie-Ann Delane - YMCA
Zac Jones (V)
Vina Danger (V)
Dipesh Patel (V)
Rhonda Chamberlain (V)
Shannon Wall (V)
Christine Dalsto (V)
Yvonne Branski (V)
Chantelle Tinnes (V)
Ashley Church (V)
Natalie Nowa

Regrets

Kim Fowler - community rep
Bibi Corbeil - teacher rep
Vasco Serrador (V)
Rene Corbeil (V)
Amy Ellison (V)
Rebecca Goodard
Cindy Ma (V)
Stephanie MacLachlan (V)
Selena Mather (V)

Meeting Minutes

1. **Welcome & Introductions**
   - Mr Wilson shared the territorial acknowledgment from the staff meeting.
   - The school and WRDSB is moving towards territorial acknowledgment being about action:
     - KNOW - learn more
     - DO - take action to engage
     - BE - be open and willing to engage
   - Social Justice for all students. Meeting their needs while respecting their backgrounds.

2. **Principals Update**
   - April 24 PD Day was about AI and School improvement.
     - AI should be helpful, responsible and useful
     - All AI use takes place within a “Walled Garden”, no access by outside elements
     - Students and Teachers will need to be signed into their School Account to use
     - As with most technology the students are ahead of the teachers
     - Currently GR 7/8s have access.
     - There is a learning curve to how to use it successfully in the classroom
     - Tools to check for AI use will not be used by the WRDSB
     - Opportunity for a Parent information night next year about AI in classrooms
   - Sprint to the end of the year.
   - EQAO
     - Primary - May 25-28
     - Junior - June 2-5
   - GR 7/8 track and field meets.
   - May 29 - PD Day, teachers will be working on report cards.
   - June 22 - Primary Play Day.
   - June 24 - Grade 8 celebration.
   - 2026/2027 WRDSB School Calendar is out. School Starts September 08.
   - Idea for a Walking School Bus run by parent volunteers:
     - 4 proposed walking routes with students picked up along the route
     - Hopeful to be running for Fall 2026
     - Students living on side streets will need to be brought to the route meeting point
     - Parent volunteers will need to provide a Vulnerable Sector Check
     - Ideally volunteers would only need to do a few shifts a week
     - Supported by School Admin
     - Volunteer Coordinator needed
     - Will require lots of upfront organisation.
     - Student Transportation has done this before.
     - This is in response to parents asking for support in getting students to/from school
     - Possibility that GR 7/8s could help.

3. **Budget Summary**
   - Ended at $63.7K
   - Cash of $50.8k and bingo $12.9k. Bingo will generate revenue over Summer as well.
   - Strong financial situation with no concerns, approx $40k of council funds unassigned.
   - Main change was bingo and pizza incomings.
   - Expenses that went out were book fair and scientist in schools.
   - PALS pinnies were purchased and have arrived.
   - School Sign total cost $8121.08. Second installment of invoice still to be paid.
   - Music approx $7k still to be spent.
   - Outdoor equipment has been purchased and awaiting delivery.
   - $1566 spent on sensory and movement items. K4 is a half class without dedicated ECE, so this equipment allows them to have independent physical activity in the classroom.

Teacher advised it is being used all the time and is very beneficial. There is a tentative list for more items to purchased, the school just needs to make a final decision. Some items will be able to be signed out by other classes from the SpecEd classroom.

- Board Game grant covered all the costs of Family Game Night.
- Year End Trip still has $7.5k to go out.

4. WRAPSC Update

- Local Trustee elections in October 2026. Trustees oversee the WRDSB and are responsive to their local constituents. They advocate above the Superintendent level.
- WRDSB Trustee meetings are available on YouTube.
- If any parents are interested in being a Trustee there is information on the WRDSB website.
- WRAPSC executive is resigning. Anyone interested in joining should contact WRAPSC.

5. Fund allocations

- Proposal for freezies to be provided for Primary Play Day, GR4-6 Track & Field and Jays Care Club. Jumbo freezies would be purchased and cut in half. Estimating 200 freezies needed for 400 kids.
    - Motion to vote on $135.53 for freezies
        - 10 YES, motion PASSED
- Community Garden revival:
    - Looking for volunteers: C. Dalsto, C. Tinnes & A. Church volunteered
    - Proposal to turn 4 planters into a butterfly garden and 4 planters into a vegetable garden
    - Use funds to buy plants/seedlings. Aiming for commonly used vegetables e.g. tomatoes, lettuce, beans etc
    - Proposed planting during first week of June
    - Requesting funds of $400. Chair proposed that the funds come from the underused Community Engagement Funds
        - NO objections
- End of Year Celebration:
    - Current approx costs of $465.00:
        - DJ $160
        - Pizza for volunteers $100
        - Popcorn $205
        - Planning to purchase tableclothes/clipsfor $89.20 so provided tables don't need to be cleaned
    - Requesting funds of $750. Chair proposed that the funds come from the underused Community Engagement Funds.
        - NO objections

6. Fund Options

- Quote for volleyball posts are being sought. Possibly a Fall 2026 project.
- More basketball nets are priced at approx $6.5k each.
- Playground enhancements of less than $10k can be done internally. Over $10k requires a lengthy approval process.
- Proposal to spend unassigned funds on an accessible slide with ramp.
- Leftover funds from the playground improvement fundraiser (approx $22k) should be used on the playground as was originally intended. Is this enough funds for an accessible slide?
- It is hard to know the price of equipment as the cost are only announced at the end of the approval process.
- Motion for $12k for volleyball nets and 1 basketball net, and all leftover unallocated funds to be used for an accessible playground.
    - 10 YES, motion PASSED

7. Read-A-Thon

- 240 students signed up and 145 packages were returned.
- 37 kids read over 1000 minutes.
- Over $2000 raised.
- Local authors were great and provided connections that could lead to future opportunities for the school.
- Other schools have asked about the Read-A-Thon due to its success.
- A. Church and C. Tinnes put in tremendous work for the Read-A-Thon and it was very well received.

8. Principal Profile Discussion

- Survey to provide School Council input for future Principal placement.
- Chair asked if School Council would be amenable to Chair and Mr. Wilson completing the survey together. There were NO objections from the council. Chair noted that any thoughts on the survey could be sent directly to the Chair.

9. Upcoming Events

- May 19 - Whole School pizza party
- May 21 - Track & Field GR4-6
- June 02 - Kindy “Meet the teachers” @ 5:30pm. Volunteer required for School Council table. C. Tinnes volunteered.
- June 10 - End of Year Celebration 5:30-7:30. No real update, meeting again soon.
- June 22 - Primary Play Day GR K-3
- June 24 - GR 8 Graduation

10. Meeting close

- Next meeting 14 October 2026
- C. Serrador is stepping down as Chair
- V. Serrador is stepping down as Bingo Coordinator
- Meeting will include voting for:

    - Chair / Co-Chair
    - Secretary
    - Treasurer
    - Communications Officer
    - Voting Members
- Also looking to fulfil the following roles of Bingo Coordinator, WRAPSC Parent Rep and Pizza Coordinator. Meeting will also be for General Volunteers and visiting members